

Complete Step-by-Step Guide

Google Indexing + SEO for a Client Website

From first access to final client report: every step explained in depth, with checklists, code snippets, troubleshooting and a 2-day delivery plan.

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Part 1: How Google Works (read this first)

Before touching the website, understand the three stages. Every SEO task you do supports one of them. When something goes wrong, you can find which stage failed.

Stage 1: Crawling

Googlebot (Google's robot) finds pages by following links and by reading your sitemap. It requests the URL, downloads the HTML, and, for JavaScript sites, later renders it. If robots.txt blocks a URL, or the server is slow or returns errors, crawling fails.

Stage 2: Indexing

Google analyses the page content and decides whether to store it in its database (the index). A page can be crawled but not indexed if it is duplicate, thin, low quality, set to noindex, or canonicalised to another URL. **Only indexed pages can appear in search results.**

Stage 3: Ranking

When someone searches, Google picks pages from the index and orders them using hundreds of signals: relevance to the query, content quality, backlinks, page experience (speed, mobile), location, and more.

Stage	Your job	Main tools
Crawling	Make pages reachable: sitemap, internal links, no blocks, fast server	robots.txt, sitemap, Screaming Frog
Indexing	Make pages worth indexing: unique content, correct canonical, no noindex	Search Console URL Inspection, Page indexing report
Ranking	Make pages relevant and trusted: keywords, content, links, speed, local signals	Keyword Planner, PageSpeed, backlinks, GBP

Realistic timelines

- **Indexing:** a few hours to 4 weeks for a new site. You can request it, but you cannot force it.
- **Google Business Profile verification:** instant to 5 days.
- **Rankings:** low-competition local terms may move in 2 to 6 weeks; competitive terms take 3 to 6+ months.
- **Never promise** a ranking position or a date for page 1. Promise the work you deliver.

Part 2: Pre-Work (before you change anything)

Step 2.1: Collect access from the client

Delays in getting access are the number one reason projects run late. Send this list on day zero.

Item	Why you need it
Website admin / CMS login (WordPress, Shopify, custom admin)	To edit titles, meta, content, plugins
Hosting or deployment access (cPanel, Netlify, Vercel, VPS, GitHub repo)	To add robots.txt, sitemap, redirects, code changes
Domain registrar / DNS access (GoDaddy, Namecheap, Cloudflare etc.)	For Search Console domain verification and redirects
Google account the client wants as owner	So the client owns Search Console, GA4 and GBP, not you
Business details: exact name, address, phone (NAP), hours, services, areas served	For local SEO, schema and citations
Logo, photos of shop / team / work, about text	For Google Business Profile and directories
Existing social profiles and any old Google Business listing	Avoid duplicate listings

Pro tip: Ask the client to add **your Gmail as Owner or Full user** in Search Console and GA4. Never ask for their Google password.

Step 2.2: Install your toolkit (all free)

Tool	Use
Google Search Console	Indexing, queries, errors. The most important tool.
Google Analytics 4	Traffic and conversion tracking
PageSpeed Insights (pagespeed.web.dev)	Core Web Vitals and speed issues
Screaming Frog SEO Spider (free up to 500 URLs)	Crawl the site like Google: titles, status codes, canonicals, noindex
Google Keyword Planner (needs a free Google Ads account)	Search volume ideas
Ubersuggest / AnswerThePublic / Google autosuggest	Extra keyword ideas, questions
Rich Results Test (search.google.com/test/rich-results)	Validate schema
Mobile-Friendly check via Lighthouse in Chrome DevTools	Mobile usability
Google Sheets	Keyword map, citation tracker, checklist

Step 2.3: Take a baseline snapshot

Record the starting point so you can prove results later. Do this before any change.

- 1 In Google, search **site:clientdomain.com**. Note how many pages appear. That is a rough count of indexed pages.

- 2 Screenshot the result and note the date.
- 3 Run PageSpeed Insights on the homepage and 2 key pages (mobile and desktop). Screenshot the scores.
- 4 Run a Screaming Frog crawl. Export the Internal tab to CSV. Save it as 'before-crawl.csv'.
- 5 Search the client's brand name and 3 main service keywords. Note where the site appears (or does not).
- 6 Check if Search Console or GA already exist for the domain (ask the client).

Note: The 'site:' operator is approximate, not exact. Use Search Console's Page indexing report as the real source of truth once set up.

Part 3: Google Search Console Setup

Search Console (GSC) is Google's official dashboard for your website. It tells you which pages are indexed, which are not, and why.

Step 3.1: Add the property

- 1 Go to **search.google.com/search-console** and sign in with the Google account that should own it.
- 2 Click the property dropdown (top-left), then **Add property**.
- 3 Choose the property type (see the table below).

Type	What it covers	Verification	Recommendation
Domain	All subdomains, http and https, www and non-www	DNS TXT record only	Best choice if you have DNS access
URL prefix	Only the exact prefix you enter (e.g. https://www.example.com/)	HTML file, HTML tag, GA4, GTM, or DNS	Use if no DNS access. Enter the exact final URL version.

Step 3.2: Verify ownership

Method A: DNS TXT record (Domain property)

- 1 GSC shows a TXT record value like: google-site-verification=abc123...
- 2 Log in to the domain registrar or DNS host (GoDaddy, Namecheap, Cloudflare, etc.).
- 3 Open DNS settings and add a record: Type = TXT, Host/Name = @ (root), Value = the string from Google, TTL = automatic or 3600.
- 4 Save, wait 5 to 30 minutes (sometimes up to 24 hours), then click **Verify** in GSC.

Method B: HTML tag (URL prefix)

Add the meta tag Google gives you inside the **<head>** of the homepage:

```
<meta name="google-site-verification" content="YOUR_CODE_HERE" />
```

In a React app this goes in public/index.html (or in your Helmet / Next.js head). Deploy, then click Verify. Do not remove the tag later, or verification can be lost.

Method C: HTML file upload

Download the file Google gives (googleXXXX.html) and upload it to the site root so it opens at https://example.com/googleXXXX.html. In React/Vite put it in the **public** folder.

Method D: Google Analytics or Tag Manager

If GA4 or GTM is already installed on the site with the same Google account, GSC can verify instantly.

Warning: Add both the https://example.com and https://www.example.com versions as URL-prefix properties if you do not use a Domain property. Otherwise you may look at the wrong version and see no data.

Step 3.3: Add users and settings

- Settings > Users and permissions > Add user: add the client as **Owner** and yourself as **Full** user.
- Settings > Associations: link GA4 to Search Console (after GA4 is set up).
- Check Settings > Crawl stats later to see how often Google visits.

Step 3.4: Learn the key reports

Report	What it tells you
Overview	Quick view of clicks, impressions, indexing summary
Performance > Search results	Queries, pages, countries, devices, clicks, impressions, CTR, average position
URL Inspection (top search bar)	Status of one URL: indexed or not, canonical, last crawl, live test, request indexing
Indexing > Pages	All URLs grouped as Indexed or Not indexed with the reasons
Indexing > Sitemaps	Submit and monitor sitemaps
Experience > Core Web Vitals / Page Experience	Speed and usability grouped by status
Enhancements	Detected structured data: breadcrumbs, FAQ, products, etc.
Security and manual actions	Penalties or hacking issues (should be empty)

Part 4: Google Analytics 4 Setup

GA4 measures what visitors do. SEO without measurement cannot be proven to the client.

- 1 Go to **analytics.google.com** and click Admin > Create > Account (use the client's business name).
- 2 Create a **Property** (set time zone to India and currency INR, or the client's country).
- 3 Add a **Web data stream** with the site URL. Copy the **Measurement ID** (G-XXXXXXXXXX).
- 4 Install the tag using one method below.
- 5 Test: open the website, then in GA4 go to Reports > Realtime. You should see yourself.
- 6 Admin > Product links > Search Console links: link the GSC property.
- 7 Mark key events as conversions (see below).

Installing the GA4 tag

Plain HTML / React (public/index.html)

```
<!-- Google tag (gtag.js) -->
<script async src="https://www.googletagmanager.com/gtag/js?id=G-XXXXXXXXXX"></script>
<script>
  window.dataLayer = window.dataLayer || [];
  function gtag(){dataLayer.push(arguments);}
  gtag('js', new Date());
  gtag('config', 'G-XXXXXXXXXX');
</script>
```

For WordPress use the **Site Kit by Google** plugin, which installs GA4 and connects Search Console in one flow. For Next.js use @next/third-parties/google or add the script in the layout.

Single Page Apps: GA4's Enhanced Measurement automatically tracks history changes in most cases. Confirm in Realtime by navigating between routes.

Set up conversions (what the client actually cares about)

- **Phone call clicks:** track clicks on tel: links as an event.
- **WhatsApp clicks:** track clicks on wa.me links.
- **Contact / enquiry form submissions:** fire an event on successful submit or on the thank-you page.
- In GA4: Admin > Events > mark the event as a Key event (conversion).

```
// Example: track a form submission in React
gtag('event', 'generate_lead', { method: 'contact_form' });

// Example: track phone click
<a href="tel:+919999999999"
  onClick={() => gtag('event', 'phone_click')}>Call us</a>
```

Part 5: robots.txt

robots.txt is a text file at the site root (<https://example.com/robots.txt>) telling crawlers which areas they may crawl. It controls **crawling, not indexing**. Blocking a URL in robots.txt does not remove it from Google, and Google cannot see a noindex tag on a blocked page.

Step 5.1: Check the existing file

- 1 Open <https://example.com/robots.txt> in the browser.
- 2 If it shows a 404, create one. If it shows **Disallow: /** for all user-agents, the entire site is blocked. This is the most common cause of 'my site is not on Google' (often left over from the staging/development phase).
- 3 In GSC, check Settings > robots.txt report for fetch errors.

Step 5.2: Write a correct robots.txt

A safe default for most business sites:

```
User-agent: *
Allow: /
Disallow: /admin/
Disallow: /cart/
Disallow: /checkout/
Disallow: /search?
Disallow: /api/

Sitemap: https://www.example.com/sitemap.xml
```

- **Never** disallow CSS, JS or image folders. Google needs them to render the page.
- Use the exact final domain (https and www/non-www as chosen) in the Sitemap line.
- Keep admin and private areas blocked, but remember robots.txt is public, so do not list secret URLs.

Step 5.3: Where to put the file

Stack	Location
Plain HTML / cPanel	public_html/robots.txt
React (Vite / CRA)	public/robots.txt
Next.js	public/robots.txt or app/robots.ts
Express / Node	app.get('/robots.txt', ...) or serve from a static folder
WordPress	Settings > Reading: untick 'Discourage search engines'. Yoast/RankMath can edit robots.txt

Step 5.4: Common mistakes

- Leftover **Disallow: /** from staging.
- WordPress 'Discourage search engines from indexing this site' box ticked.
- SPA hosting that returns index.html (status 200) for /robots.txt, so crawlers read HTML instead of rules. Make sure a real file exists.
- Blocking /wp-content/ or /static/ which hides CSS and JS.

Note: After editing, open the URL in the browser to confirm it displays plain text, then re-check in GSC.

Part 6: XML Sitemap

A sitemap is a list of the URLs you want Google to index. It helps Google discover pages faster and shows you indexing stats per sitemap.

Step 6.1: Rules for a good sitemap

- Include only **canonical, indexable, 200-status** pages. No redirects, 404s, noindex pages or parameter duplicates.
- Use full absolute URLs with the correct protocol and domain version.
- Max 50,000 URLs or 50 MB per file; use a sitemap index for more.
- Add accurate **<lastmod>** dates (only update when content really changes). Google largely ignores priority and changefreq.

Step 6.2: Create the sitemap

Option 1: WordPress

Yoast SEO, Rank Math or the built-in `/wp-sitemap.xml` create it automatically. Check `/sitemap_index.xml`.

Option 2: Static site or small React site (manual)

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<urlset xmlns="http://www.sitemaps.org/schemas/sitemap/0.9">
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.example.com/</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-10-06</lastmod>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.example.com/services</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-10-06</lastmod>
  </url>
  <url>
    <loc>https://www.example.com/contact</loc>
    <lastmod>2026-10-06</lastmod>
  </url>
</urlset>
```

Save as `sitemap.xml` in the site root (public folder in React).

Option 3: Generate with a crawler

Screaming Frog (Sitemaps > XML Sitemap) can export a sitemap from a crawl. Remove any non-indexable URLs before uploading.

Option 4: Auto-generate in Node / Next.js

```
// Express example for dynamic pages (e.g. blog posts from MongoDB)
app.get('/sitemap.xml', async (req, res) => {
  const posts = await Post.find({ published: true });
  const urls = ['/', '/services', '/contact',
    ...posts.map(p => '/blog/' + p.slug)];
  const xml = '<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>' +
    '<urlset xmlns="http://www.sitemaps.org/schemas/sitemap/0.9">' +
    urls.map(u => '<url><loc>https://www.example.com' + u +
      '</loc></url>').join('') + '</urlset>';
  res.header('Content-Type', 'application/xml').send(xml);
});
```

Step 6.3: Submit to Google

- 1 Open the sitemap URL in a browser and confirm it loads as XML.
- 2 In GSC go to **Indexing > Sitemaps**.
- 3 Enter 'sitemap.xml' (or the full path) in 'Add a new sitemap' and click Submit.
- 4 Status should show **Success**. 'Couldn't fetch' usually means a wrong path, a blocked file, or an HTML response instead of XML.
- 5 Check back in 2 to 3 days: it shows 'Discovered URLs'.

Note: Submitting a sitemap does not guarantee indexing. It only tells Google the URLs exist.

Part 7: Requesting and Speeding Up Indexing

Step 7.1: URL Inspection and 'Request indexing'

- 1 Paste a full page URL into the top search bar in GSC.
 - 2 Read the result: 'URL is on Google' (indexed) or 'URL is not on Google'.
 - 3 If not indexed, click **Test live URL** to confirm Google can fetch and render the page right now.
 - 4 If the live test is fine, click **Request indexing**.
 - 5 Repeat for the homepage, main service pages, contact page and the best blog posts.
- There is a daily quota (roughly 10 to 20 requests per property per day). Prioritise the most important pages first.
 - Requesting repeatedly for the same URL does not make it faster.
 - Use **View crawled page** and the screenshot to check Google sees the full content, not an empty page (important for React).

Step 7.2: What helps Google index faster

- **Internal links:** link every new page from the homepage, menu or related pages. Orphan pages (no links) are often skipped.
- **Sitemap:** submitted and error-free.
- **Backlinks and social links:** a link from an already-crawled site leads Googlebot to your page.
- **Google Business Profile:** adding the website URL provides a crawl path.
- **Fast, stable server:** repeated 5xx errors or timeouts slow crawling.
- **Unique, useful content:** thin or duplicate pages are often 'Crawled, currently not indexed'.
- **Fresh content:** regular updates and new posts signal an active site.

Step 7.3: Bing and other engines (quick extra)

Add the site to **Bing Webmaster Tools** (you can import from GSC in one click). Bing also powers DuckDuckGo and others. Bing supports IndexNow for instant URL pings.

Step 7.4: Things that do NOT work (avoid)

- Paid 'instant Google indexing' services and spam link blasts. They can harm the site.
- The old Google 'ping' sitemap endpoint (retired).
- Using the Indexing API for normal pages. It is officially only for job posting and livestream pages.

Part 8: Technical SEO Audit and Fixes

Run a Screaming Frog crawl and work through each item. For each fix, note before and after in your report.

8.1: HTTPS

- Site must load on https with a valid SSL certificate (free via Let's Encrypt, Cloudflare, or host).
- All http URLs must 301-redirect to https.
- Fix 'mixed content' (http images, scripts on https pages). Check the browser console for warnings.

8.2: One canonical domain version

These four versions must not all load separately: <http://example.com>, <http://www.example.com>, <https://example.com>, <https://www.example.com>. Choose one (usually https + www or https + non-www) and 301-redirect the other three to it.

```
# Apache .htaccess example (force https + www)
RewriteEngine On
RewriteCond %{HTTPS} off [OR]
RewriteCond %{HTTP_HOST} !^www\. [NC]
RewriteRule ^(.*)$ https://www.example.com/$1 [L,R=301]
```

On Netlify use a `_redirects` file or `netlify.toml`; on Vercel use `vercel.json` redirects; on Cloudflare use a Redirect Rule.

8.3: Status codes

Code	Meaning	Action
200	OK	Good for live pages
301	Permanent redirect	Use when moving a URL. Avoid chains (A to B to C)
302	Temporary redirect	Change to 301 if the move is permanent
404	Not found	Fix internal links to it; redirect to the closest relevant page if it had value
410	Gone	Use for intentionally removed pages
5xx	Server error	Fix hosting/app errors immediately
'Soft 404'	200 status but looks empty / 'not found' text	Return a real 404 or add real content (common in SPAs)

8.3b: Fix broken links and redirect chains

- 1 In Screaming Frog: Response Codes tab > filter Client Error (4xx). Click a URL, then the 'Inlinks' tab to see where the broken link sits.
- 2 Update or remove each broken internal link.
- 3 Reports > Redirects > Redirect Chains. Point the first URL straight to the final URL.
- 4 Re-crawl to confirm.

8.4: Canonical tags

The canonical tag tells Google which URL is the master version when similar URLs exist (tracking parameters, www/non-www, filters).

```
<link rel="canonical" href="https://www.example.com/services/" />
```

- Every indexable page should have a **self-referencing** canonical.
- Must be an absolute URL, same protocol and domain as your chosen version.
- Do not canonicalise every page to the homepage (a common React Helmet mistake).

8.5: noindex checks

- Search page source for **noindex** in meta robots or an X-Robots-Tag HTTP header.
- Use noindex deliberately on thank-you pages, internal search results, admin pages.
- Make sure no important page carries it (often left by the developer or plugin).

```
<meta name="robots" content="index, follow" />    <!-- default, can be omitted -->
<meta name="robots" content="noindex, follow" />  <!-- for pages to exclude -->
```

8.6: Mobile-friendliness

- Google uses the **mobile version** for indexing (mobile-first). Content hidden on mobile may not count.
- Add .
- Tap targets large enough, text readable without zoom, no horizontal scrolling.
- Test on a real phone and in Chrome DevTools device mode.

8.7: Speed and Core Web Vitals

Metric	Good	What it measures
LCP (Largest Contentful Paint)	2.5 s or less	How fast the main content appears
INP (Interaction to Next Paint)	200 ms or less	Responsiveness to taps/clicks
CLS (Cumulative Layout Shift)	0.1 or less	Visual stability (no jumping)

Common quick wins:

- Compress and resize images; convert to **WebP/AVIF**; set width and height attributes (prevents CLS).
- Lazy-load below-the-fold images: loading="lazy". Do NOT lazy-load the main hero image; preload it.
- Minify CSS/JS, remove unused libraries, code-split routes in React.
- Enable **Gzip/Brotli** compression and browser caching on the server or CDN.
- Use a CDN (Cloudflare free plan is enough for most clients).
- Limit web fonts (2 weights), use font-display: swap.
- Defer third-party scripts (chat widgets, heavy trackers).

8.8: URL structure

- Short, readable, lowercase, hyphens: /physiotherapy-in-coimbatore not /page?id=57.
- Avoid changing URLs after launch; if you must, 301 redirect old to new.
- Avoid duplicate paths for the same content (trailing slash vs non-slash: pick one).

8.9: Custom 404 page and internal structure

- Create a helpful 404 page that returns a true 404 status and links to the main pages.
- Keep important pages within 3 clicks of the homepage.
- Add a clear menu and footer links to key pages.

8.10: Audit scoring sheet

Check	Pass?	Fix applied
HTTPS valid, all http redirects		
Single canonical domain		
robots.txt correct		
Sitemap valid and submitted		
No accidental noindex		
No 404 internal links / no redirect chains		
Mobile-friendly		
LCP / INP / CLS in good range		
Canonicals self-referencing		
Content visible without relying on slow JS		

Part 9: React / MERN SEO (critical for your stack)

Plain client-side React (Create React App or Vite SPA) sends Google an almost empty HTML file with a JavaScript bundle. Google can render JavaScript, but it happens in a second, delayed wave, which can slow indexing, cause missing content, and weakens titles/meta for each route. Other crawlers (Bing, social previews, WhatsApp, LinkedIn) often do not run JS at all.

Step 9.1: Diagnose

- 1 Right-click the page > View Page Source (not Inspect). If you see only `<div id="root"></div>`, content is client-rendered.
- 2 In GSC URL Inspection > Test live URL > View tested page > Screenshot and HTML. Confirm headings and text are present.
- 3 Check each route has a different title and meta description in the rendered HTML.

Step 9.2: Choose a fix

Option	Effort	Best for
A. react-helmet-async for titles/meta (still client-rendered)	Low	Tiny brochure sites; limited benefit alone
B. Prerendering at build time (react-snap, vite-plugin-ssg, prerender.io)	Low to medium	Mostly static content, few pages
C. Migrate to Next.js (SSR / SSG)	Medium to high	Best long-term for SEO; blogs, e-commerce, many pages
D. Rebuild small brochure pages in static HTML or WordPress	Medium	When site is simple and SEO is the priority

Step 9.3: react-helmet-async example

```
npm i react-helmet-async

// index.js
import { HelmetProvider } from 'react-helmet-async';
<HelmetProvider><App /></HelmetProvider>

// Services.jsx
import { Helmet } from 'react-helmet-async';
<Helmet>
  <title>Physiotherapy Services in Coimbatore | Clinic Name</title>
  <meta name="description"
    content="Expert physiotherapy for back pain, sports injuries
    and rehab in Coimbatore. Book an appointment today." />
  <link rel="canonical" href="https://www.example.com/services" />
  <meta property="og:title" content="Physiotherapy Services" />
  <meta property="og:image" content="https://www.example.com/og.jpg" />
</Helmet>
```

Step 9.4: Prerender with react-snap (quick option)

```
npm i -D react-snap
// package.json
"scripts": { "postbuild": "react-snap" },
"reactSnap": { "inlineCss": true }

// index.js: hydrate if prerendered
import { hydrate, render } from 'react-dom';
const root = document.getElementById('root');
if (root.hasChildNodes()) hydrate(<App />, root); else render(<App />, root);
```

Note: react-snap is old and works best on simple sites. For new or growing sites, Next.js is the safer long-term path.

Step 9.5: React-specific rules

- Use real **** links (React Router `<Link>` renders these). Google does not follow onClick-only navigation.
- Avoid hash URLs (`/#/about`). Use `BrowserRouter` with clean paths.
- Configure the server to return real 404 status for unknown routes where possible, or add a `noindex` to the not-found component.
- Do not hide important text behind clicks/tabs that load only after interaction.
- Ensure the host serves `/robots.txt` and `/sitemap.xml` as real files, not the SPA `index.html`.
- Each route needs its own unique title, description, H1 and canonical.

Step 9.6: Netlify / Vercel SPA fallback caution

A `_redirects` rule like `/* /index.html 200` makes every unknown URL return status 200, creating soft 404s. Keep real files (`robots.txt`, `sitemap.xml`) above that rule so they are served first, and add a proper 404 handling approach.

Part 10: Keyword Research and Page Mapping

Step 10.1: Understand search intent

Intent	Example	Page type
Informational	how to relieve lower back pain	Blog / guide
Commercial	best physiotherapy clinic Coimbatore	Service / comparison page
Transactional / local	physiotherapist near me, book physio RS Puram	Service + location page, GBP
Navigational	The Origin Physiotherapy	Homepage / brand

Step 10.2: Build the seed list

- 1 List every service/product the client sells (each is a seed).
- 2 Add locations: city, areas, nearby towns (e.g. Coimbatore, RS Puram, Gandhipuram, Peelamedu).
- 3 Add modifiers: best, near me, cost/price, clinic, online, 24 hours, for [problem].
- 4 Check **Google autosuggest** and 'People also ask' and 'Related searches' for real phrasing.
- 5 Look at 3 top-ranking competitors' titles and headings for the same terms.
- 6 Enter seeds into **Google Keyword Planner** (Discover new keywords) and Ubersuggest to get volume ideas.
- 7 In GSC Performance (after a few weeks) look for queries with impressions but low position: they are quick wins.

Step 10.3: Choose keywords

- Prefer **specific, relevant, achievable** terms: 'knee pain physiotherapy Coimbatore' over 'physiotherapy'.
- Local business: city + service terms deliver the best return.
- Volume matters less than relevance and conversion intent. 50 searches/month of 'book X in city' beats 5,000 of a vague term.
- Check the search results: if page 1 is full of big directories or national brands, pick a longer-tail variant.

Step 10.4: Map one primary keyword to one page

Never target the same primary keyword on two pages (keyword cannibalisation). Use a sheet like this:

Page URL	Primary keyword	Secondary keywords	Intent	Status
/	physiotherapy clinic coimbatore	physio clinic RS Puram, best physiotherapist	Local/commercial	Pending
/back-pain-treatment	back pain treatment coimbatore	lower back pain physio	Commercial	Pending
/blog/neck-pain-exercises	neck pain exercises	desk neck pain relief	Informational	Pending
/contact	clinic name contact	address, phone, map	Navigational	Pending

Part 11: On-Page SEO

Step 11.1: Title tag

- Appears as the blue link in search. Strongest on-page signal.
- **50 to 60 characters** (about 580 px wide). Longer titles get cut off.
- Pattern: **Primary keyword + benefit/qualifier | Brand**.
- Unique for every page. Put the main keyword near the start. No keyword stuffing.

Good: Back Pain Treatment in Coimbatore | The Origin Physiotherapy
Bad: Home
Bad: Physiotherapy, Physio, Physiotherapist, Best Physio Coimbatore

Step 11.2: Meta description

- Not a direct ranking factor, but drives **click-through rate**.
- **140 to 155 characters**. Write like an advert: benefit + keyword + call to action.
- Unique per page. Google may rewrite it, which is fine.

Suffering from back pain? Our expert physiotherapists in Coimbatore offer personalised treatment plans. Book your appointment today.

Step 11.3: Headings (H1 to H3)

- Exactly **one H1** per page, containing the primary keyword naturally.
- H2s for main sections, H3s for sub-points. Use headings for structure, not for styling.
- Use question-style H2s where it fits (they match 'People also ask' and featured snippets).

Step 11.4: Page content

- Answer the searcher's question fully. Typical service page: **500 to 1,000+ words**; blogs 800 to 1,500+. Length follows usefulness, not a fixed number.
- Put the primary keyword in the first 100 words, and use synonyms and related terms naturally.
- Include proof of expertise: qualifications, experience, case studies, testimonials, team photos (E-E-A-T: Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trust). Health and finance sites are held to higher standards.
- Add a clear call to action: phone, WhatsApp, booking button.
- Show address, hours and map for local pages.
- Add an FAQ section answering real customer questions (also feeds FAQ schema).
- No copied or duplicated text across pages or from other sites.

Step 11.5: Images

- Descriptive file names: back-pain-physiotherapy-coimbatore.webp not IMG_2931.jpg.
- Alt text describing the image naturally: 'Physiotherapist treating a patient's lower back'. Do not stuff keywords.
- Compress (aim under 150 KB for normal images), serve WebP, set width/height.

- Use original photos where possible (team, clinic) for trust.

Step 11.6: Internal linking

- Link related pages with **descriptive anchor text** ('knee pain treatment') not 'click here'.
- Every important page should receive links from the homepage or menu plus 2 to 3 relevant pages/posts.
- Blog posts link to the matching service page; service pages link to relevant posts.
- Add breadcrumbs on deeper pages.

Step 11.7: External links and social tags

- Link out to authoritative sources when useful (opens in new tab with rel="noopener").
- Add Open Graph and Twitter tags so links look good on WhatsApp, Facebook, LinkedIn.

```
<meta property="og:type" content="website" />
<meta property="og:title" content="Page title" />
<meta property="og:description" content="Short description" />
<meta property="og:image" content="https://www.example.com/og-1200x630.jpg" />
<meta property="og:url" content="https://www.example.com/page" />
<meta name="twitter:card" content="summary_large_image" />
```

Step 11.8: Per-page on-page checklist

Item	Done
Primary keyword chosen and unique to this page	
Title 50-60 chars with keyword	
Meta description 140-155 chars with CTA	
One H1, logical H2/H3 structure	
Keyword in first 100 words and URL	
Images compressed, named, alt text added	
2-3 internal links in and out	
CTA and contact info visible	
Canonical tag correct, indexable	
Schema added where relevant	

Part 12: Schema Markup (Structured Data)

Schema is code that tells Google exactly what the page is about (a business, an FAQ, a product). It can unlock rich results (stars, FAQ dropdowns, breadcrumbs) and improves understanding. Use **JSON-LD** format placed in the page head or body.

Step 12.1: LocalBusiness schema (homepage / contact)

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "LocalBusiness",
  "name": "Client Business Name",
  "image": "https://www.example.com/logo.jpg",
  "url": "https://www.example.com/",
  "telephone": "+91-9999999999",
  "priceRange": "$$",
  "address": {
    "@type": "PostalAddress",
    "streetAddress": "12 Main Road, RS Puram",
    "addressLocality": "Coimbatore",
    "addressRegion": "Tamil Nadu",
    "postalCode": "641002",
    "addressCountry": "IN"
  },
  "openingHoursSpecification": [{
    "@type": "OpeningHoursSpecification",
    "dayOfWeek": ["Monday", "Tuesday", "Wednesday", "Thursday", "Friday", "Saturday"],
    "opens": "09:00", "closes": "19:00"
  }],
  "sameAs": [
    "https://www.facebook.com/clientpage",
    "https://www.instagram.com/clientpage"
  ]
}
</script>
```

Use a more specific type where it exists (e.g. Physiotherapy, MedicalClinic, Dentist, Restaurant, HairSalon). Your NAP must exactly match Google Business Profile.

Step 12.2: FAQPage schema

```
<script type="application/ld+json">
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "FAQPage",
  "mainEntity": [{
    "@type": "Question",
    "name": "How many sessions will I need?",
    "acceptedAnswer": {
      "@type": "Answer",
      "text": "It depends on the condition. Most patients need 4 to 8 sessions."
    }
  }
]}
</script>
```

Note: Google now shows FAQ rich results only for a limited set of well-known authoritative sites, so do not promise FAQ dropdowns. The markup is still harmless and helps understanding. The visible page must contain the same Q and A text.

Step 12.3: BreadcrumbList schema

```
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@type": "BreadcrumbList",
  "itemListElement": [
    { "@type": "ListItem", "position": 1, "name": "Home", "item": "https://www.example.com/" },
    { "@type": "ListItem", "position": 2, "name": "Services", "item": "https://www.example.com/services" }
  ]
}
```

Step 12.4: Other useful types

- **Article / BlogPosting:** for blog posts (author, date, image).
- **Product + Offer + AggregateRating:** for e-commerce.
- **Organization:** logo, social profiles, contact.
- **Service, Review:** only with real, visible reviews (never fake).

Step 12.5: Validate

- 1 Open search.google.com/test/rich-results and test the live URL or paste the code.
- 2 Fix errors (red) and consider warnings (yellow).
- 3 After indexing, check GSC > Enhancements for detected items.

Warning: Never add schema for content that is not visible on the page, or fake review ratings. This can trigger a manual action.

Part 13: Content Creation

Step 13.1: Decide what to publish

- **Service pages** (one per service) and **location pages** (only if genuinely different and useful, not copy-paste with city swapped).
- **Blog posts** answering customer questions from keyword research.
- **About, Team, Testimonials, Case studies** for trust.
- **FAQ page or sections** from real customer calls and WhatsApp questions.

Step 13.2: Blog post writing process

- 1 Pick one keyword and the intent behind it.
- 2 Open the top 5 results and note their headings, depth, and what is missing.
- 3 Create an outline: H1, intro answering the question quickly, H2 sections, FAQ, conclusion with CTA.
- 4 Write for the reader first: plain language, short paragraphs, examples, local relevance.
- 5 Add original value: client's experience, photos, numbers, steps, checklists.
- 6 Optimise title, meta, headings, images, internal links.
- 7 Proofread, publish, add to sitemap, request indexing, share on social and GBP.

Step 13.3: Using AI tools responsibly

AI can speed up first drafts, outlines, meta descriptions and FAQ ideas. Google does not penalise AI content by itself, but it penalises low-quality, mass-produced, unhelpful pages. Always: fact-check, add real expertise and local details, edit for natural tone, and avoid publishing raw output. For medical, legal or financial topics, have a qualified person review.

Step 13.4: Content quality checklist

- Does it answer the question better than the current top results?
- Is it unique (no copy from other sites)?
- Is it accurate, current and written/reviewed by someone qualified?
- Is it easy to read on mobile?
- Does it lead the reader to a next step?

Part 14: Local SEO and Google Business Profile

For clinics, shops, schools, studios, restaurants and service businesses, local SEO (Maps and 'near me' results) often brings more customers than organic website rankings. The three main local factors are **relevance, distance, and prominence**.

Step 14.1: Create or claim the profile

- 1 Search the business name and address on Google Maps to see if a listing already exists. If yes, click **Claim this business**. If not, go to **business.google.com** and create one.
- 2 Use the client's real business name only (no keywords added; this violates guidelines and risks suspension).
- 3 Choose the **primary category** carefully (e.g. Physiotherapist). It is the strongest relevance signal. Add 2 to 4 relevant secondary categories.
- 4 Enter address (or service area for businesses that travel to customers), phone, website URL, hours.
- 5 Verify (see step 14.2).

Step 14.2: Verification

- Methods: postcard, phone/SMS, email, or **video recording** of the premises, signage and tools (increasingly common).
- Postcards take 5 to 14 days; video review can take 1 to 5 days.
- Do not create the profile for a fake address or a virtual office; it will be suspended.
- Start this on day 1, since it runs in the background.

Step 14.3: Complete every field

- **Description** (750 characters): what the business does, who for, where. Natural wording with the main keyword once.
- **Services / products** with descriptions and prices if possible.
- **Photos**: logo, cover, exterior, interior, team, work samples. At least 10 to 15 real photos. Add new ones monthly.
- **Attributes**: wheelchair access, women-led, online appointments, etc.
- **Appointment / booking link**, WhatsApp number, social links.
- **Opening hours**, including special hours for festivals.
- **Q and A**: add common questions and answers yourself.
- **Posts**: offers, updates, events. Publish regularly (weekly or fortnightly).

Step 14.4: NAP consistency

Name, Address, Phone number must be **identical everywhere**: website, GBP, directories, social pages, schema. Even 'Road' vs 'Rd.' differences can dilute trust. Write the exact NAP once in a sheet and copy-paste it every time.

Step 14.5: Reviews

- Reviews are a top local ranking and conversion factor.

- Get the **review link** from GBP (Get more reviews) and create a QR code. Place at reception, in invoices, and send via WhatsApp after service.
- Ask every happy customer; reply to **all** reviews, including negative ones, politely.
- Never buy reviews or offer incentives, never review-gate. This breaks guidelines.
- Mention services naturally in your replies.

Step 14.6: On the website

- Embed a Google Map on the contact page.
- Show NAP in the header or footer as text (not only an image).
- Add LocalBusiness schema, location/service area pages if relevant, and local testimonials.
- Link the GBP profile in the footer or contact page.

Step 14.7: Local citations (directories)

Citations are mentions of the business NAP on other sites. For India, common starting points:

Type	Examples
Major local directories	Justdial, Sulekha, IndiaMART (for B2B), TradeIndia, Yellow Pages India, Grotal
Maps and search engines	Google Business Profile, Bing Places, Apple Business Connect
Social	Facebook Page, Instagram, LinkedIn Company, YouTube, X
Industry-specific	Practo (health), Lybrate, UrbanClap/Urban Company, Zomato (food), MagicBricks (property), school/college directories etc.
Local	Chamber of commerce, local business associations, local news sites

Pro tip: Create a Google Sheet with columns: Directory, URL, Login email, Password hint, Date, Status, Live link. This makes work fast and lets you hand the client a proof sheet.

Part 15: Off-Page SEO (Backlinks and Authority)

Backlinks are links from other websites to the client's site. Quality and relevance matter far more than quantity. A few links from relevant, trusted local sites beat hundreds of spam links.

Safe and effective link-building methods

- **Citations and directories** (Part 14.7): easy foundation links, mostly nofollow or low value but important for local trust.
- **Partners and suppliers:** ask businesses the client works with to link from their 'partners' or 'where to buy' pages.
- **Local sponsorships and events:** sponsor a school event or sports club, which often earns a link.
- **Local press and blogs:** pitch a story (new service, milestone, community work).
- **Guest posts** on relevant local or industry blogs with real value.
- **Own social profiles** linking to the site.
- **Unlinked brand mentions:** search the brand name; ask sites that mention it to add a link.
- **Resource and tool pages,** helpful guides, infographics or free tools worth linking to.
- **Student/association/professional body** membership pages.

Avoid (can cause penalties)

- Buying links in bulk, link farms, PBNs.
- Mass blog-comment or forum spam, and automated link-blasting tools.
- Exact-match keyword anchor text overload.
- Link exchanges at scale ('you link me, I link you' everywhere).

Check links and disavow

Check the Links report in GSC. Google ignores most spam links automatically. Only use the Disavow tool when you have a manual action or clear evidence of a paid-link scheme; for normal sites it is rarely needed.

Part 16: Indexing Problems: Troubleshooting Every Status

Go to GSC > Indexing > Pages. Click each reason to see affected URLs, then use URL Inspection on one example. Use this table:

Status	Meaning	How to fix
Discovered - currently not indexed	Google knows the URL but has not crawled it yet (often crawl budget/quality)	Improve internal links, content quality, server speed; wait; request indexing for key pages
Crawled - currently not indexed	Google visited but chose not to index (thin, duplicate, low value)	Add unique, useful content; merge or remove weak pages; add internal links; improve E-E-A-T
Duplicate without user-selected canonical	Google sees duplicate pages and you set no canonical	Add self-canonicals; consolidate duplicate pages; 301 redirect variants
Duplicate, Google chose different canonical than user	Google disagrees with your canonical	Make content distinct or make signals consistent (links, sitemap, canonical all point to the same URL)
Alternate page with proper canonical tag	Normal: the page points to another canonical	No action unless the wrong URL was chosen
Excluded by 'noindex' tag	Page tells Google not to index	Remove noindex if page should rank; confirm in page source and headers
Blocked by robots.txt	Google cannot crawl the URL	Edit robots.txt; test the URL; remember noindex needs crawl access
Page with redirect	URL redirects elsewhere	Normal for old URLs; make sure sitemap lists final URLs only
Not found (404)	URL does not exist	Restore, redirect, or remove internal links to it
Soft 404	Page looks empty or 'not found' but returns 200	Add real content or return a true 404/410
Server error (5xx)	Server failed when Google visited	Check hosting logs, uptime, resources; fix and re-test
Redirect error	Loop or too many redirects	Fix redirect rules and chains
Submitted URL not selected as canonical	URL in sitemap, but Google prefers another	Check duplicates; fix canonical and sitemap
Indexed, though blocked by robots.txt	Indexed via links, content not readable	Unblock if you want it to rank; use noindex properly otherwise

Quick decision flow for 'my page is not on Google'

- 1 Search the exact URL in Google. If it appears, it is indexed (just not ranking).
- 2 URL Inspection: what does it say? Read the reason.
- 3 Click Test live URL. Does it load? Is the rendered screenshot complete?
- 4 Check robots.txt, noindex (meta and header) and canonical.
- 5 Check content: is it thin, duplicated, or JS-hidden?
- 6 Check internal links: does a crawlable link to it exist? Is it in the sitemap?

7 Fix, then Request indexing and wait 1 to 2 weeks before re-checking.

After a site move, redesign or domain change

- Keep a spreadsheet mapping old URLs to new URLs and 301 redirect each one.
- Keep the old domain's redirects for at least a year.
- Use GSC Change of Address tool for domain moves.
- Re-submit sitemap and watch coverage daily for 2 to 3 weeks.

Removing unwanted pages from Google

- Use GSC > Removals for urgent temporary hiding (about 6 months).
- For permanent removal: delete the page (404/410) or add noindex, and keep it crawlable so Google can see it.

Part 17: Monitoring, Reporting and Client Handover

Step 17.1: What to check and when

When	Check
Day 1	GSC verified, sitemap submitted, GA4 live
Day 3 to 7	Pages indexed count (Pages report), sitemap status, URL Inspection of key pages
Week 2	Performance report: first impressions; fix any new errors; GBP verification status
Week 4	Compare indexing, impressions, clicks to baseline; check Core Web Vitals; citations live
Month 3	Rankings and traffic trend; leads from organic and GBP; plan next steps

Step 17.2: Key metrics to report

- **Indexing:** number of pages indexed vs submitted.
- **Search Console:** clicks, impressions, CTR, average position, top queries and pages.
- **Analytics:** organic users, engagement, conversions (calls, forms, WhatsApp).
- **GBP Insights:** searches, views, calls, direction requests, website clicks.
- **Speed:** before and after PageSpeed scores and Core Web Vitals.
- **Work done:** list of fixes with screenshots.

Step 17.3: Final report structure (send as PDF)

- 1 Summary: what was done, in plain language, 1 page.
- 2 Before and after: PageSpeed scores, indexed pages, issues fixed (screenshots).
- 3 Technical fixes completed (list).
- 4 On-page changes per page (table: URL, new title, new meta, keyword).
- 5 Local SEO: GBP link, status, citations list with live links.
- 6 Content published.
- 7 What to expect and timeline (indexing, rankings).
- 8 Recommended next steps and optional monthly plan with price.
- 9 Access and ownership summary: where the accounts are and who owns them.

Step 17.4: Handover items

- Search Console and GA4 owner access confirmed to the client.
- GBP ownership with the client's account.
- Spreadsheet of keywords, citations and logins (shared securely).
- A short guide: how to add new pages (title, meta, internal links, request indexing).
- Date for a free follow-up check (2 and 4 weeks).

Part 18: 2-Day Delivery Plan

Note: All work can be done in two intense days (about 16 to 20 hours). Indexing, GBP verification and rankings still depend on Google's timeline. Collect all access BEFORE day 1.

Day 0: Prep (1 to 2 hours, before the clock starts)

- Receive all access, NAP, photos, and service list.
- Prepare spreadsheets: keyword map, citation tracker, NAP master.
- Take baseline screenshots and crawl.

Day 1: Technical + setup + research

Time	Task	Part
0:00 - 1:00	Search Console verify, GA4 install, link both	3, 4
1:00 - 1:45	robots.txt fix, sitemap create + submit	5, 6
1:45 - 2:15	Start GBP creation and verification (runs in background)	14
2:15 - 4:00	Crawl audit, list all issues by priority	8
4:00 - 7:00	Fix HTTPS/redirects/canonical/broken links/images/speed	8
7:00 - 9:30	React: Helmet or prerender/SSR setup, deploy, verify rendering	9
9:30 - 11:00	Keyword research (15 keywords), map to pages	10

Day 2: On-page, content, local, report

Time	Task	Part
0:00 - 3:00	Titles, meta, H1, alt text, internal links for 10 to 12 pages	11
3:00 - 4:00	Schema: LocalBusiness, FAQ, breadcrumbs, test	12
4:00 - 6:30	Write and publish 2 blog/service pages	13
6:30 - 7:30	Finish GBP: photos, services, description, posts	14
7:30 - 9:30	20 directory listings and social profile links	14.7
9:30 - 10:15	Request indexing for key pages; re-submit sitemap	7
10:15 - 11:15	Final report + handover	17

Warning: Do not rush technical fixes. Test redirects and robots.txt after every change. One wrong Disallow or noindex can remove the entire site from Google.

After day 2 (free follow-ups)

- Day 5 to 7: check indexed pages and sitemap status; request indexing for stragglers.
- Week 2: GBP verified? Add reviews link. Fix any new GSC errors.
- Week 4: send a short progress update, then offer the monthly plan.

Part 19: Pricing, Scope and Contract Template

Packages (one-time project, India market)

Package	Price	Scope
Basic Setup + Indexing	Rs. 3,000	GSC, GA4, sitemap, robots.txt, 5 pages on-page, request indexing, short report. 1 GBP and 5-10 directories only if scoped
Complete Project	Rs. 25,000	Full audit and fixes, 15 keywords, 10-12 pages on-page, schema, 2 content pieces, full GBP, 20 citations, final report, 2-4 weeks free support
Optional monthly (after project)	Rs. 5,000 - 12,000/month	Monitoring, content, citations, links, reports

Clients outside India (for example in Sri Lanka) can often pay more; quote in USD or LKR at a fair rate.

Scope statement to copy into your quote

PROJECT: SEO and Google Indexing Setup for [Client / Website]
FEE: Rs. [25,000] one-time. 50% advance, 50% on delivery.
TIMELINE: Delivery within [2] working days after receiving all access and content. Client delays pause the timeline.

INCLUDED:

- Search Console + GA4 setup and verification
- robots.txt and XML sitemap creation and submission
- Indexing requests for key pages
- Technical audit and fixes (https, redirects, canonical, links, speed)
- Keyword research: 15 keywords mapped to pages
- On-page SEO for up to [12] pages
- Schema markup (LocalBusiness, FAQ, Breadcrumb)
- [2] blog/service pages
- Google Business Profile setup and optimisation
- [20] directory listings
- Final report with before/after

NOT INCLUDED:

- Guaranteed rankings or traffic
- Paid ads and paid backlinks
- Ongoing monthly monitoring/content
- Redesign, development outside SEO scope, extra pages
- Indexing timeline (decided by Google)

REVISIONS: 1 round per deliverable.
SUPPORT: [2] weeks free fixes on delivered work, then hourly rate.
CLIENT PROVIDES: website/hosting/DNS access, business details, photos, approvals within 3 working days.

Protect yourself

- Get written approval of scope and the advance payment before starting.
- Take a full backup of the website (files + database) before making changes.
- Use a staging copy for risky changes if possible.
- Document every change (a simple change log).
- Make the client the owner of all accounts.

Part 20: Master Checklist and Glossary

Master checklist

#	Task	Done
1	All access received from client	
2	Baseline snapshot (site:, PageSpeed, crawl) saved	
3	Search Console verified; client added as owner	
4	GA4 installed, tested in Realtime, conversions set	
5	robots.txt correct and live	
6	Sitemap created, valid, submitted, status Success	
7	HTTPS + single canonical domain redirects working	
8	Broken links and redirect chains fixed	
9	No accidental noindex; canonicals correct	
10	Mobile-friendly; Core Web Vitals improved	
11	React rendering solved (Helmet/prerender/SSR) and verified in GSC	
12	Keyword research done and mapped to pages	
13	Titles, meta, H1, alt text, internal links done	
14	Schema added and validated	
15	Content published (blog/service pages)	
16	Google Business Profile created, verified, completed	
17	NAP consistent; citations submitted	
18	Review link/QR given to client	
19	Indexing requested for key pages; Bing Webmaster added	
20	Final report sent; handover and follow-up dates set	

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Crawl	Googlebot visiting and reading a URL
Index	Google's database of stored pages
SERP	Search engine results page
Canonical	The preferred URL among duplicates
noindex	Instruction telling Google not to index a page
Sitemap	File listing URLs to be indexed
Backlink	A link from another website to yours
Anchor text	The clickable words of a link

Term	Meaning
NAP	Name, Address, Phone number
Citation	A mention of a business's NAP on another site
GBP	Google Business Profile
CTR	Click-through rate: clicks divided by impressions
Core Web Vitals	Google's speed and stability metrics: LCP, INP, CLS
E-E-A-T	Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, Trustworthiness
SSR / SSG	Server-side rendering / static site generation
Schema / JSON-LD	Structured data format that describes page content
Orphan page	A page with no internal links pointing to it

Note: Google changes its tools and guidelines often. Features, limits and quotas mentioned here (such as indexing request quotas and rich result eligibility) can change, so check Google Search Central documentation (developers.google.com/search) when in doubt.